

DASHBOARD WALKTHROUGH

Starbucks Beverage Analytics Dashboard

How to read, filter, and use the Power BI executive view

Audience	Purpose
Business managers, marketing, product, nutrition, and BI teams	A practical guide to navigate dashboard visuals and interpret results responsibly.

1. Start Here: Executive Overview

The dashboard is organised for a quick executive scan. Start with the headline KPI cards, then move to category comparisons, item-level rankings, and the store-presence view. Every result should be interpreted within the active filters shown on the report page.

Recommended reading order

Step	Visual area	What to look for
1	KPI cards	Visible beverage count and average calories, sugar, and caffeine.
2	Beverage distribution	The category mix behind the current selection.
3	Nutrition comparisons	How categories differ on average, with units visible.
4	Top caffeine ranking	Individual drinks that lead in the selected context.
5	Global presence	How recorded stores distribute across available geography.

What the KPI cards mean

Card	Interpretation guidance
Total Beverage Count	Count of distinct drinks in the current filter context. A smaller number after filtering is expected.
Average Calories	Mean energy value across visible valid beverage records; confirm the serving basis.
Average Sugar (g)	Mean sugar amount for the current selection; grams should be shown in the label or tooltip.
Average Caffeine (mg)	Mean caffeine amount for visible valid records; distinguish blanks from zeroes or decaf values.

2. Explore Beverage Categories

Use the category distribution visual before drawing conclusions from an average. It establishes how many beverages contribute to each category and helps avoid over-reading a small group. Select a category to focus the report on a narrower comparison set.

Nutrition comparison visuals

Visual	How to read it	Business use
Average Calories by Category	Compare category means; inspect count and serving basis before treating a difference as material.	Identify groups for product or communication review.
Average Sugar by Category	Read values in grams and compare with category size.	Support lower-sugar exploration and transparency discussions.
Average Caffeine by Category	Use for directional comparison, then drill into item ranking.	Support product education and assortment conversations.

Good analysis habits

- Hover for tooltips before making an interpretation.
- Compare categories under the same filter state.
- Treat averages as summaries; inspect beverages behind a large or unexpected result.
- Do not compare records with different serving bases without clear normalisation.
- Use the reset control before beginning a new question.

3. Use the Top Caffeine Ranking

The top-caffeine visual is the bridge between category-level patterns and specific menu items. It should rank beverages by their documented caffeine value within the active report context, allowing users to see which items lead after applying category or beverage selections.

Action	Expected result	Interpretation
Select a category	Ranking narrows to drinks in that category.	Shows leaders within a relevant comparison group.
Clear category selection	Ranking returns to all visible drinks.	Useful for portfolio-wide exploration.
Hover a ranked item	Tooltip displays item detail and unit.	Use this to verify the displayed value and context.
Compare with average caffeine	Item results are considered alongside the category/portfolio benchmark.	Avoids using the mean as an item-level statement.

Important limitation

The ranking is descriptive. It does not advise consumption, infer customer choice, or represent health guidance. Caffeine values must be interpreted with the source-documented serving basis, completeness rules, and appropriate stakeholder review.

Useful follow-up questions

- Does the selected category have a wide range of caffeine values?
- Are the top-ranked beverages representative of a broader category pattern or isolated items?
- Are blank or unavailable caffeine values excluded and explained?

4. Read the Global Presence View

The global presence visual presents the available store-location data by country or region. Its purpose is to help users understand the recorded footprint and concentration of the network, not to estimate sales, demand, margin, or market performance.

Use case	How to interact	Caution
Footprint concentration	Select a country/region or inspect visual tooltips.	Validate whether the source contains individual stores or pre-aggregated counts.
Market comparison	Compare displayed locations under a consistent source date.	Different coverage periods can make comparisons misleading.
Regional discussion	Use standardised country/region labels and any approved mapping.	Do not infer commercial performance from store count alone.

Filtering rules

Geographic filters should control the store-presence visual. They should not change beverage nutrition KPIs unless the model includes an approved, meaningful common dimension. This prevents accidental duplication or a false implication that a beverage nutrition record belongs to a particular market.

Before presenting an insight

Confirm the geography level, source date, coverage, unit of counting, and whether the visual uses store IDs or a pre-aggregated count. These details determine whether a visible difference can be responsibly discussed.

5. Filter, Share, and Validate

Interactive filters are the main exploration mechanism. Use them to refine questions, not to manufacture a preferred outcome. Always capture the active filter state when sharing a finding.

Task	Recommended practice
Filter	Apply one selection at a time; observe which visuals respond and whether that behaviour is intended.
Reset	Return to default view before answering a separate question.
Share	Record filter choices, refresh/source date, and the exact metric shown.
Validate	Compare key outputs with a small sample calculation or source record.
Escalate	Flag unexpected blanks, totals, labels, or interaction behaviour to the report owner.

Quick checklist

- I know the active filters and date/source version.
- I can state the metric, unit, and serving basis.
- I checked count context before interpreting an average.
- I have not inferred sales, demand, or health outcomes from descriptive visuals.
- I can reproduce the view for a stakeholder.

Data availability note

This walkthrough reflects the declared dashboard scope: KPI cards, global presence, beverage distribution, nutrition comparisons, top caffeine drinks, and interactive filters. Original source attachments and dashboard image were not available in the handoff workspace; replace generic labels and add validated figures once those assets are restored.